

Lab 4.1: Multi-Party Negotiation Simulation

Introduction

This hands-on lab gives you practice orchestrating a deal with several stakeholders. You will analyze a scenario with multiple decision-makers, build a coalition plan, and propose a negotiation sequence designed to reach your objective. The goal is to practice thinking several moves ahead, deciding who to meet, in what order, and why.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to

- Map stakeholders in a multi-party deal by power and interest.
- Build a coalition plan that lines up support before key meetings.
- Propose a negotiation sequence that maximizes leverage.



Scenario

You are a senior Account Executive at PayPro Solutions, working to close a payroll and benefits deal with a mid-sized company. The decision involves four stakeholders, and they do not all want the same thing:

Stakeholder	Role/power	What they care about	Current leaning
Dana Okafor	CFO; controls budget, can veto	Total cost and clear return on investment	Skeptical; worried about price
Marcus Lee	HR Director; would own the relationship	Less manual work, better compliance, good support	Strongly in favor; your champion
Priya Shah	IT Manager; advises on integration	Clean integration, low disruption to systems	Neutral; cautious about switching
Tom Reyes	COO; final approver, time-pressed	A smooth decision that the team supports	Neutral; will follow the group's lead

You cannot get everyone in one room easily. Your task is to build a coalition plan and propose a sequence of meetings to reach a yes.

Tools Overview

Stakeholder and Sequencing Principles:

The principles from this lesson: map stakeholders on a power-interest grid, build coalitions by securing support before group meetings, manage the budget-holder's veto, and sequence one-on-one conversations before the group decision so you walk in with alignment rather than litigating it live.

Resource Files

Lab 4.1 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)

Instructions

Exercise 1: Build the Coalition Plan

Objective: Decide who to win, in what order, and how.

Step 1: Map power and interest

Place each stakeholder by their power over the decision and their interest in it. Identify your champion, the potential veto, and the neutral parties who will follow the group.

Step 2: Plan your coalition

Decide who you secure first and how you use them. Note how you will address the CFO's veto specifically, and how you will neutralize the IT Manager's concern before it becomes an objection in front of the group.

Exercise 2: Propose a Negotiation Sequence

Objective: Lay out the order of meetings that gives you the best chance of a yes.

Step 1: Sequence the meetings

Propose the order in which you will meet these stakeholders. Decide what happens in one-on-one versus in the group and explain why each comes where it does. Generally, you want to build alignment privately before any group decision.

Step 2: Write the group meeting agenda

Draft a brief agenda for the final group meeting. By the time you reach it, the meeting should confirm a decision the group is already leaning toward, not open a debate for the first time.

Lab Output/Expected Outcome

By the end of this lab, you should have:

- A coalition plan: who you secure first, how you handle the veto, and how you neutralize concerns.

- A proposed meeting sequence with a rationale for the order.

A brief agenda for the final group meeting.

Summary

Congratulations. You have orchestrated a complex, multi-party deal on paper, the kind of planning that separates sellers who get blindsided in group meetings from those who walk in with the decision already aligned. The best multi-party negotiators win the deal before the final meeting, not during it.

Compare your work to the Lab 4.1 Exemplar Solution.
